

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Ramesh Mareguddi

Address: 45 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Objection to DM2025/01591 - material planning reasons

1) Highway safety risk in a highly sensitive area (school-run + pedestrians)

- The proposal sits within an area of very high pedestrian activity, including children and parents with buggies, because Avenue Primary Academy has 1,034 pupils.
- School activity extends beyond normal pick-up: the school's published wraparound offer provides childcare until 5:45pm (term time), extending parent pick-ups and child crossings into the early evening.
- Any increase in peak traffic, drop-offs, turning, and on-street parking will materially increase pedestrian safety risk at already busy times.

2) Constrained road network and limited resilience (single access / cul-de-sacs)

- Dorset Road functions as a constrained access route to the site and nearby roads; Balmoral Way is a cul-de-sac with limited turning space. Increased overspill parking and "circling" traffic leads to more reversing/3-point turns and reduced visibility-this is a classic highway safety concern in cul-de-sac layouts.
- Any obstruction (double-parking, drop-offs, deliveries) can disproportionately affect flow and emergency/refuse access because there are limited alternative routes.

3) Peak intensity is high for a residential street location (capacity + late dispersal)

- The applicant's Fire Strategy states: "Total maximum capacity for the building = 297 persons."
- The Council's pre-application feedback (repeated in applicant documents) explicitly notes "up to 250 attendees might depart around 11 pm" for Friday prayers / large community events.
- These are significant peaks for a residential street with limited capacity and sensitive receptors (families, elderly residents).

4) Parking provision is demonstrably insufficient and applicant's own "worst case" relies on heavy on-street parking

- The Transport Statement models a worst-case Friday changeover and says there could be "up to 80 vehicles" parked within the site car park and on-street locally.
- It confirms 14 on-site spaces, assumes 3 used by staff, leaving 11 for attendee remaining 69 vehicles*** would park on surrounding streets in the worst case.
- This is not a minor overspill - it is a material increase in on-street parking demand which risks:
 - blocked driveways and pavements,
 - reduced junction visibility,
 - conflict with school-run movement,
 - obstruction risk for emergency/refuse vehicles.

5) The "overlap" assumptions indicate frequent peak pressure, not occasional blips

- The Transport Statement assumes overlap of: "all 160 visitors from Session 1 and 90 visitors from Session 2... at the same time."
- It also references "240-250 attendees... across the Friday Prayer sessions per Friday."
- These figures demonstrate the proposal is capable of generating regular, repeatable peak that all streets are not designed to absorb.

6) Residential amenity harm from late-evening dispersal and associated noise

- The pre-app concern referenced by the applicant is specifically about late dispersal around 11pm.
- Even if internal noise is managed, late dispersal typically creates external disturbance (voices, car doors, engines idling, vehicles searching for spaces). In a quiet residential area this is a material amenity issue.

7) Cumulative impacts are not properly addressed (other venues already create peaks on/near Dorset Road)

This proposal is being assessed as if the background network is "neutral", but nearby venues already generate arrivals/departures and event peaks.

- Sutton Bowling Club states it has over 500 members and is open "8.00am until late seven days per week."

- Downs Lawn Tennis Club advertises hall hire that can cater for up to 80 people.
- Downs Lawn Tennis Club also advertises Friday evening jazz events (e.g., 06 Mar 2026, 19:00-23:00 at 50 Holland Ave, SM2 6HU).

These are foreseeable overlapping peaks (evenings/weekends and Friday evenings in particular). The highways evidence should test cumulative event overlap, not just this proposal in isolation.

8) Risk of net increase in trips (not a true "relocation")

- The application does not demonstrate that activity at the current venue will permanently cease or that similar use will not continue there under another group. Without any binding "offset", there is a credible risk the area ends up with two active venues, producing a net increase in trips and parking pressure rather than displacement.

9) Equality / vulnerable residents - access and safety

- Overspill parking and pavement obstruction disproportionately affects elderly residents, those with mobility impairments, and families with pushchairs by forcing people into the carriageway and reducing safe crossing visibility. This is relevant to safe access and residential amenity.

What I'm asking the Council to do

I respectfully request council to Refuse the application due to unacceptable highway safety, parking stress, and residential amenity impacts, especially given the applicant's own worst-case on-street parking reliance and late-evening dispersal concerns.